

partnership, aimed at handling smartphone OEM orders and expanding manufacturing capabilities, will strengthen both companies' positions in India's market. The deal awaits final agreements, conditions, and regulatory approvals.

### Panasonic and T-Hub collaborate to drive startup innovations

Panasonic, in partnership with startup incubator T-Hub, has announced four finalists for its 'Innovation Challenge.' Startups Ayka Control Systems, GoVidyouth Mobility, PureLogic Labs India, and Xeed IO will collaborate with Panasonic and the India Innovation Center to commercialise Nessum WIRE technology. This challenge, launched in September 2024, seeks innovative solutions for data communication in challenging environments, spanning sectors like clean energy and deep-tech.

### Micromax and Phison join hands for storage chip design

Micromax has partnered with Taiwan's Phison to create MiPhi, a joint venture aimed at designing and manufacturing storage chips, including SSDs, in India. Micromax will hold a 55% stake, while Phison will own 45%. The venture, based in Noida, plans to reduce reliance on foreign technology and enhance self-sufficiency in storage solutions for sectors like AI, enterprise, and automotive.

### ESC seeks funding, DLI scheme revision for electronics R&D

The Electronics and Computer Software Export Promotion Council (ESC) has called for reforms in India's electronics sector, urging a refinement of the Design Linked Incentive (DLI) scheme, additional tax incentives for R&D, and increased funding in Budget 2025. ESC seeks enhanced support for innovation, tax relief on IP-based products, and a US\$20 billion boost for emerging technologies like quantum computing.

### Global industry giants unite in VLSID 2025, Bengaluru

The 38th International Conference on VLSI Design and the 24th Conference on Embedded Systems, organised by the VLSI Society of India, were inaugurated on January 6, 2025, in Bengaluru. The event, themed 'Silicon Meets AI,' highlighted innovations in AI, 5G, IoT, and quantum computing. Over 2700 registrants participated in 18 keynote sessions, panel discussions, and exhibits showcasing India's growing semiconductor landscape.

### DPIIT and boAt join hands to support startups

The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has partnered with Indian audio and wearable brand boAt to support startups in the D2C and manufacturing sectors. The MoU focuses on mentoring, resources, and guidance for startup growth, including prototype development and international expansion. This collaboration fosters innovation, product development, and globally competitive brands.



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